

07 – Cover Letter

Ashby – Senior Marketing Manager, Enterprise ABM EMEA

I'm reaching out as someone who has spent the last several years building exactly the kind of demand generation, pipeline, and growth systems that teams like yours eventually need to scale with confidence.

My name is James. I'm a demand generation and growth operator with 7+ years of hands-on experience across B2B and SaaS companies in Africa, North America, and Europe. In that time, I've been the first or early marketing hire multiple times, responsible for taking ambiguous problems, shaping strategy, and then executing deeply across demand generation, ABM, and multi-channel campaign orchestration. I'm sharing this as context for how I think, tailored to what Ashby is building: a genuinely first-principles ABM motion for enterprise EMEA, not a checklist run off someone else's playbook.

I'm drawn to work that compounds, roles where ownership and long-term thinking matter more than surface-level output. Part of why I started Marketing In Action, a newsletter documenting real GTM systems rather than theory, and kept it running alongside client work.

My work has centered on demand generation, ABM, and multi-channel campaign orchestration. Across these engagements, I've contributed to over \$10M in qualified pipeline and helped teams achieve measurable improvements in funnel velocity, conversion, and pipeline attribution. A recurring pattern in my career is being trusted to build demand engines from scratch, designing ABM programs, launching campaigns across new channels, and building measurement infrastructure that proves what actually drove the pipeline.

I do my best work at the intersection of product, marketing, and growth. In Ashby's context, that means:

- Building the target account methodology itself. At FunnelEnvy, I built the Target Account Strategy and ABM Playbook on Clay, ExactBuyer, and Instantly, driving a 31% lift in enterprise meeting bookings.
- Combining data and creative judgment as one job. Repositioning Reform for a mixed technical and business audience drove a 34% trial activation lift, work that lived in the messaging and the numbers at the same time.
- Coordinating external partners and agencies toward one growth outcome. At CIL, that meant managing AWS, Google, and Microsoft partnerships that fed a multi-country Academy launch, a different format than a gifting agency but the same underlying orchestration.
- Running structured experimentation, short sprints with a clear read on what worked. The ICEEE framework I built at FunnelEnvy cut experimentation cycles by 35% while keeping campaigns fast-iterating.

I want to be direct about one thing: I haven't run dinner events, OOH activations, or gifting campaigns specifically, the tactics Ashby names in this JD. What I have done is build and manage multi-party partnerships and agency relationships toward a shared pipeline number, which is the same coordination skill in a different format.

What actually interests me is building systems that hold up as pipeline scales. In several roles, I've built marketing functions from zero: choosing tools, setting cadence, deciding what not to do. I'm most effective in

environments where responsibility is clear and marketing is expected to shape direction, which is why Ashby's "low ego, highly ambitious" framing and explicit distrust of generic playbooks feels aligned with how I like to operate.

I build my own AI-native growth tooling (Claude Code, n8n, Clay) as part of daily work: github.com/realjaymes/marketingagentskills.

I put together a short read on how I'd approach building a first EMEA target account list that reflects real market nuance, treating Europe as several distinct markets rather than one segment.

Thank you for taking the time to read this.

James

P.S. I've created a portfolio focused on this role at jamespraise.xyz/work/ashby/.

Pitch microsite: Built 2026-09-10 at jamespraise.xyz/work/ashby/, see [[10 – Pitch Microsite]]. P.S. line above carries the Kawai Cheung convention.